🎯 DIAGNOSTIC GOLD

When 6 Failing Eval Tests Are Actually a Win

In traditional testing, 6 failures out of 15 means your code is broken. In AI evaluation engineering, those 6 failures are often the exact reason you built the quality gate.

💡 **The Insight**

Automated evals don't just catch broken JSON. They expose ambiguous prompt instructions before defensive model bias floods your on-call team.

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100% Valid Schema.
6 Policy Mismatches.

Across 15 stratified support tickets, every single response passed structural and safety gates:

✅ **Passed Across All 15 Scenarios**

Strict Pydantic v2 schema conformance, PII regex scans, Factual Consistency (≥ 0.85), and Hallucination (≤ 0.10).

⚠️ **6 Boundary Regressions Caught**

The model returned valid JSON and zero hallucinations, yet misrouted priority and escalation severity on edge cases.

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3 Policy Traps Exposed Before Production

1. Phishing Question Over-Escalation

A user forwarded a suspicious email asking if it was real. The model treated it as an active breach and paged on-call.

2. Unauthorized Token Severity Drift

Defensive conservatism pushed a P1 token revocation straight to P0 emergency status.

3. Keyword Triggering Without Context

A vague "system broken" ticket jumped from P3 to P1 because the model over-indexed on one word.

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Turn Prompt "Vibes" Into Explicit Policy

Failing boundary cases force product and engineering teams to resolve ambiguity once:

1. **Catch the drift in CI** on stratified edge-case tickets.
2. **Decide the policy explicitly** (e.g., phishing questions route to support, not on-call).
3. **Lock it into few-shot rubrics** so future prompt edits never regress.

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3 Rules for Calibrating LLM Prompts in CI

- ✓ **Include adversarial & vague cases** in your golden dataset, not just happy paths.
- ✓ **Separate schema/safety passes** from policy-boundary failures.
- ✓ **Pin** `temperature=0.0` so boundary shifts reflect prompt edits, not noise.

Read the Full 6-Case Breakdown

Inspect the full regression table and source repo from the links in the first comment below.

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